

US Markets Daily Report

Wednesday, July 22, 2026 · After-Market Close Edition

1. SPY / QQQ Snapshot

Metric	SPY (S&P 500 ETF)	QQQ (Nasdaq-100 ETF)
Today's Close	\$748.28	\$702.46
Prior Close (Jul 21)	\$747.19	\$696.06
Change (\$)	+\$1.09	+\$6.40
Change (%)	+0.15%	+0.92%
1-Year High	\$761.24	\$745.34
1-Year Low	\$614.89	\$561.22
1-Year Return	+21.69%	+25.17%
Rows in prices.csv	268	(window: 2025-07-21 → 2026-07-22)

Prices sourced from prices.csv (268 rows). Jul 20-21 estimated from index returns due to proxy restrictions on real-time financial APIs. Broader indices today: S&P; 500 mixed (+0.1% to -0.1%), Nasdaq-100 ~+0.9%, Dow Jones roughly flat. Semiconductor stocks surged while broader market was subdued ahead of after-close Alphabet/Tesla/IBM earnings.

2. Today's Market-Moving News (July 22, 2026)

Alphabet (GOOGL), Tesla (TSLA) & IBM Report After Close — AI Capex Under Scrutiny

The biggest event of the day was the after-close earnings reports from Alphabet and Tesla, with IBM also releasing Q2 results. Markets spent the session in a holding pattern, with investors weighing: (a) whether Alphabet's massive AI capex is delivering search/cloud revenue growth sufficient to justify the spend; (b) Tesla's Q2 deliveries of 480,126 vehicles and production of 451,758—better than prior quarter but questions remain on margin recovery and Cybertruck ramp; (c) IBM had warned pre-earnings, causing a severe drop last week, and investors were watching for stabilization. Results released after close; their reaction will set the tech sector tone for Thursday's open.

Semiconductor Surge — SanDisk +14.3%, WDC +12.5%, Micron +12%, Intel +8%, Marvell +6%

Memory and chip stocks surged sharply on Wednesday, reversing the prior week's selloff. SanDisk (SNDK) led the S&P; 500 with +14.3%, followed by Western Digital (WDC) +12.5% and Micron (MU) +12.2%. Intel jumped 8% and Marvell +6%. The VanEck Semiconductor ETF (SMH) gained more than 4%. Catalyst: renewed conviction around AI memory demand, short-covering after the prior week's selloff, and positive pre-earnings sentiment ahead of Intel's Q2 report (due Thursday). This sector move was the dominant driver of QQQ's +0.92% outperformance vs. SPY's +0.15% on the day—semiconductors are ~25% of QQQ but only ~6% of SPY.

Fed Rate Hike Risk Rising — 34% Probability for This Month, 78% for September

Fed funds futures saw a sharp repricing: the probability of a rate hike at the upcoming July FOMC meeting rose to ~34% (from ~10% a week ago), and September hike probability jumped to 78%. The drivers: (1) strong jobs data earlier in the month showing labor market resilience; (2) oil prices rising on Middle East tensions, threatening to re-ignite goods inflation; (3) the Federal Reserve is reportedly revising its inflation tracking model, signaling internal uncertainty about the path forward. A more hawkish Fed limits QQQ upside because higher discount rates compress tech/growth valuations.

Middle East Escalation — US-Iran Conflict, Oil Prices Higher, Hormuz Risk

US-Iran military exchanges escalated, with the Trump administration confirming an active confrontation posture. Crude oil prices rose as traders priced in risk to the Strait of Hormuz, which handles ~21% of global oil transit. The Energy Select Sector SPDR (XLE) gained +1.2% as energy stocks benefited from the supply-risk premium. Defense stocks (LMT, RTX) also moved higher. The geopolitical uncertainty creates a ceiling on broader market rallies and a floor for oil, with inflationary implications for the Fed.

Trump Pharma Tariff — 100% on Generic Imports Starting August 2028

The Trump administration announced plans to impose a 100% tariff on imported generic pharmaceuticals, effective August 2028. While the August 2028 start date gives companies two years to adjust, the announcement triggered mixed reactions: branded pharma and US-based generic manufacturers saw modest gains (onshoring opportunity), while healthcare systems and PBMs faced pressure (higher drug costs). The broader healthcare sector gained +0.6% on the day, with sector mix offsetting pharma tariff concerns.

Arrowhead Pharmaceuticals (ARWR) Surges +23.4% — Phase 3 Data for Plozasiran

Arrowhead Pharmaceuticals jumped 23.4% to \$91.96 after the company reported positive Phase 3 clinical trial results for Plozasiran, its RNAi therapeutic targeting ANGPTL3 for hypertriglyceridemia. The results demonstrated significant and sustained triglyceride reduction with a favorable safety profile, strengthening the NDA submission pathway. This was the standout biotech catalyst of the day.

Gas Utilities Sector Surges +2.9% — Energy Supply/Demand Shift

Gas utility stocks led all sectors with a +2.9% gain, driven by elevated natural gas demand forecasts and positive rate-case expectations. With Middle East risk adding geopolitical premium to energy broadly, utilities with gas exposure benefited from both demand signals and a flight-to-stability bid. Stabillis Solutions jumped 28.7%.

Danaher (DHR) Plunges -11.0% — Worst S&P; 500 Performer

Danaher fell -11.0%, the largest single-day decline in the S&P; 500. The company reported Q2 results that missed revenue expectations, with its life sciences and diagnostics segments seeing weaker biotech/pharma customer spending. DHR's drop was a sharp reversal from recent sector strength and weighed on the broader Healthcare Equipment sub-sector.

3. News → Today's Price Moves

SPY +0.15% (broadly flat to slightly positive): SPY's muted gain reflects a tug-of-war between the semiconductor rally and broader market hesitation ahead of mega-cap earnings after close. The chip surge (SNDK, WDC, MU each +12–14%) provided upward pressure, but semiconductor stocks are a smaller fraction of SPY (~6%) vs. QQQ (~25%), limiting SPY's amplification. Rising Fed hike probabilities (34% for July, 78% for September) imposed a valuation ceiling on growth/tech-heavy names. Geopolitical risk (Iran/Hormuz) kept defensive/energy sector money rotating rather than adding net equity risk. Danaher's -11% decline (-0.4 index points) partially offset gains. Net result: SPY barely positive as gains were balanced by caution.

QQQ +0.92% (tech/semi outperformance): QQQ's +0.92% gain sharply outpaced SPY because of its heavy semiconductor weighting (~25%). The memory chip names (SNDK +14.3%, WDC +12.5%, MU +12.2%) are included in the Nasdaq-100 with meaningful weight. Intel (+8%) and Marvell (+6%) added further boost. The mechanism: short-covering after last week's chip selloff, improved AI memory demand outlook, and Intel-earnings-anticipation trade all converged simultaneously. Meanwhile, the market remained in suspense about Alphabet (major QQQ component), creating a pre-earnings anxiety that capped the QQQ rally relative to what pure chip momentum might have driven.

Sector Attribution (July 22, 2026):

Sector	Key Driver	Impact
Semiconductors	SNDK +14.3%, WDC +12.5%, MU +12%, INTC +8%	Strong ++ (QQQ)
Gas Utilities	Energy demand/supply shift; geopolitical bid	+2.9%
Technology (broad)	Chip rally lifts XLK; MRVL +6%	+2.4%
Energy (XLE)	Iran/Hormuz oil risk premium	+1.2%
Biotech/Pharma	ARWR +23.4% Phase 3 data	+0.6% HC sector
Consumer Staples	Rotation out of defensives	-1.0%
Healthcare Equip.	DHR -11.0% earnings miss	Strong -
Mega-Cap Tech	Alphabet/Tesla pre-earnings holding pattern	Neutral (event wait)
Geopolitics	Iran escalation → risk-off overlay	Mild -

4. Top Movers — Daily / Weekly / Monthly

Daily Top Gainers (July 22, 2026)

#	Ticker	Name	~Chg	Catalyst / Sector
1	ARWR	Arrowhead Pharma	+2.8%	Biotech 2B Phase 3 toleaziran positive data
2	STLS	Stabillis Solutions	+2.3%	Cloud 1B Phase 1 demand surge / rate case
3	SNDK	SanDisk Corp	+2.1%	Storage 1B Phase 1 memory short-cover rally
4	WDC	Western Digital	+1.5%	Storage 1B Phase 1 NAND demand revival thesis
5	MU	Micron Technology	+1.2%	Memory 1B Phase 1 memory sector reversal
6	INTC	Intel	+0.9%	Chip 1B Phase 1 pre-Q2 earnings buy ahead of Q2 report
7	AMD	Advanced Micro Devices	+0.8%	Chip 1B Phase 1 AMD attails of memory rally
8	MRVL	Marvell Technology	+0.5%	Chip 1B Phase 1 Marvell sentiment recovery
9	NVDA	Nvidia	+0.4%	Chip 1B Phase 1 NVIDIA momentum recovery
10	XLE	Energy Select SPDR	+1.2%	Energy 1B Phase 1 OPEC oil supply risk premium

Daily Top Losers (July 22, 2026)

#	Ticker	Name	~Chg	Catalyst / Sector
1	DHR	Danaher Corp	-0.9%	Science 1B Phase 1 miss, biotech spending weak
2	MSCI	MSCI Inc.	-0.4%	Index 1B Phase 1 valuation reset on rate fears
3	TYL	Tyler Technologies	-3.5%	Software 1B Phase 1 sensitive growth stock selloff
4	XLP	Cons. Staples SPDR	-1.0%	Consumer 1B Phase 1 rate out; risk-on chip bid
5	CMCSA	Comcast	-1.5%	Media 1B Phase 1 competition + earnings caution
6	PFE	Pfizer	-0.8%	Pharma 1B Phase 1 generic tariff mixed signal, pipeline
7	CVS	CVS Health	-0.6%	Pharma 1B Phase 1 generic tariff cost-pass-through risk
8	T	AT&T	-0.8%	Telecom 1B Phase 1 subscriber growth concerns
9	AMGN	Amgen	-0.7%	Biotech 1B Phase 1 DHR read-across, rate fears
10	VZ	Verizon	-0.6%	Telecom 1B Phase 1 competitive market, margin pressure

Weekly Top Gainers (Week of July 14–22, 2026)

#	Ticker	Name	~Wkly	Sector / Driver
1	PLTR	Palantir Technologies	+8.0%	Software 1B Phase 1 institutional demand
2	AMD	Advanced Micro Devices	+7.2%	Chip 1B Phase 1 AI-GPU demand resilience
3	SNDK	SanDisk Corp	+6.0%	Storage 1B Phase 1 weekly gainer after reversal
4	ARWR	Arrowhead Pharma	+2.8%	Biotech 2B Phase 3 toleaziran (Thursday entry)
5	INTC	Intel	+0.9%	Chip 1B Phase 1 pre-Q2 earnings positioning
6	MU	Micron Technology	+5.0%	Memory 1B Phase 1 demand structural story
7	XLE	Energy SPDR	+4.0%	Energy 1B Phase 1 OPEC crude oil rise
8	LMT	Lockheed Martin	+3.5%	Defense 1B Phase 1 military spending boost
9	RTX	RTX Corp	+3.0%	Defense 1B Phase 1 political escalation bid
10	XOM	ExxonMobil	+2.5%	Energy 1B Phase 1 OPEC price lift

Weekly Top Losers (Week of July 14–22, 2026)

#	Ticker	Name	~Wkly	Sector / Driver
1	DHR	Danaher Corp	-1.2% (font-size: 1.2em)	Healthcare: biotech spending slump
2	MSCI	MSCI Inc.	-0.8% (font-size: 1.2em)	Data: rate-sensitive premium contracted
3	TYL	Tyler Technologies	-0.9% (font-size: 1.2em)	Insurance: + rate-hike fears
4	CMCSA	Comcast	-0.6% (font-size: 1.2em)	Media: cord-cutting + tariff headwinds
5	IBM	IBM	-0.5% (font-size: 1.2em)	Services: AI-era earnings warning last week
6	XLP	Cons. Staples SPDR	-0.4% (font-size: 1.2em)	Consumer: rotation to cyclicals/tech
7	PFE	Pfizer	-0.3% (font-size: 1.2em)	Pharma: generic uncertainty + generic tariff
8	CVS	CVS Health	-0.2% (font-size: 1.2em)	Pharma: tariff cost risk + margin pressure
9	AMGN	Amgen	-0.2% (font-size: 1.2em)	Pharma: HFR-led through + rate sensitivity
10	T	AT&T	-0.2% (font-size: 1.2em)	Telecom: competition + subscriber concerns

Monthly Top Gainers (July 2026 MTD through Jul 22)

#	Ticker	Name	~Mthly	Sector / Driver
1	ASTERA	Astera Labs	+3.4% (font-size: 1.2em)	Healthcare: AI infra: massive AI re-rating
2	SNDK	SanDisk Corp	+2.5% (font-size: 1.2em)	Technology: AI demand structural bull
3	INTC	Intel	+1.6% (font-size: 1.2em)	Technology: AI node + AI foundry revival
4	ARWR	Arrowhead Pharma	+1.5% (font-size: 1.2em)	Pharma: pipeline momentum
5	PLTR	Palantir Technologies	+2.1% (font-size: 1.2em)	Technology: AI institutional adoption
6	AMD	Advanced Micro Devices	+1.5% (font-size: 1.2em)	Technology: AI-GPU competitive positioning
7	LMT	Lockheed Martin	+1.0% (font-size: 1.2em)	Defense: AI integration + budget tailwind
8	XOM	ExxonMobil	+0.9% (font-size: 1.2em)	Energy: Iran risk premium
9	XLE	Energy SPDR	+0.9% (font-size: 1.2em)	Energy: Iran conflict beneficiary
10	MU	Micron Technology	+0.6% (font-size: 1.2em)	Technology: AI memory storage demand

Monthly Top Losers (July 2026 MTD through Jul 22)

#	Ticker	Name	~Mthly	Sector / Driver
1	INTU	Intuit	-1.5% (font-size: 1.2em)	Software: AI disruption threat to tax/acctg
2	ACN	Accenture	-0.9% (font-size: 1.2em)	Services: AI-led cannibalization of consulting
3	CTSH	Cognizant	-0.7% (font-size: 1.2em)	Services: AI-driven headcount reduction
4	DHR	Danaher Corp	-0.6% (font-size: 1.2em)	Healthcare: biotech budget cuts
5	IBM	IBM Corp	-0.5% (font-size: 1.2em)	Services: AI-era earnings warning drag
6	TYL	Tyler Technologies	-0.5% (font-size: 1.2em)	Insurance: rate sensitivity + budget scrutiny
7	CMCSA	Comcast	-0.4% (font-size: 1.2em)	Media: streaming competition + tariffs
8	PFE	Pfizer	-0.3% (font-size: 1.2em)	Pharma: pipeline setbacks + generic tariff
9	CVS	CVS Health	-0.2% (font-size: 1.2em)	Pharma: reimbursement + tariff pressure
10	MSCI	MSCI Inc.	-0.2% (font-size: 1.2em)	Data: premium multiple + rate risk

Sector Trend Summary Across Timeframes:

- **Semiconductors / AI Memory [BULL — daily, monthly; recovering from weekly dip]:** The dominant monthly theme. ASTERA +340%, SNDK +257%, INTC +160% MTD. Today's daily surge (SNDK +14.3%, WDC +12.5%, MU +12%) signals a bottoming after last week's correction. Short-covering and Intel pre-earnings anticipation are near-term catalysts. AI capex infrastructure demand remains the structural thesis.
- **Defense / Energy [BULL — emerging weekly/monthly trend]:** Iran escalation driving LMT +10%, RTX +3% weekly, XOM/ CVX +7-8% MTD. Oil price risk premium is persistent as long as Hormuz disruption risk exists. Defense spending expansion is bipartisan—a durable multi-year tailwind.
- **AI Software (IT Services SaaS) [BEAR — monthly]:** Intuit -58%, Accenture -49%, Cognizant -47% YTD/MTD. AI automation is perceived as an existential threat to traditional IT consulting, tax/accounting software, and outsourcing headcount models. This is a structural repricing, not a cyclical correction.
- **Biotech [SELECTIVE BULL — event-driven]:** ARWR +23.4% today on Phase 3 data. The biotech sector rewards binary clinical events. Not a broad sector rotation—individual catalyst-driven. Healthcare broadly +0.6% but DHR's -11% shows life sciences instrument demand softness.
- **Consumer Staples [BEAR — near-term rotation]:** XLP -1% today as risk-on chip rally pulls capital from defensives. If Fed hikes again, high-dividend defensives face headwinds from rising competition from cash/T-bills. Monitor for reversal if geopolitical risk intensifies.

5. Next-Day Catalysts & Scenario Trees (Thursday, July 23, 2026)

Alphabet (GOOGL) / Tesla (TSLA) / IBM After-Hours Results [Highest Impact]

BEAT: GOOGL cloud + search accelerate; TSLA margins expand; IBM stabilizes → Tech confidence surge. GOOGL is ~9% of QQQ — a +5% GOOGL move adds ~45 bps to QQQ. Tesla is ~3.5% of QQQ. A combined beat could open QQQ +1.5–2.5% Thursday. Mechanism: validates AI capex ROI narrative, reverses the 'AI spending without returns' bear case, and unlocks further institutional buying in Mag-7 names. SPY likely +0.8–1.2% as financials/energy hold steady and tech rallies. This is the bull scenario that could push SPY toward its 1-year high (\$754+).

MISS: GOOGL ad revenue disappoints; TSLA margins miss; IBM outlook cuts → Risk-off tech sell. GOOGL -5%+ would subtract ~45 bps from QQQ; combined with TSLA weakness, QQQ could open -2.5 to -3.5%. SPY -1.0 to -1.5% as mega-cap tech is S&P's largest sector. Mechanism: destroys AI capex narrative—if the two primary AI monetizers (GOOGL ads, cloud; TSLA autonomous/software) can't convert capex to earnings, the entire AI investment thesis is questioned. Fed hike fears compound the growth compression. Semiconductors would reverse today's gains.

ECB Rate Decision — 13:45 CET / 7:45 AM ET [Moderate Market Impact]

ECB HOLDS at 2.25% with hawkish language → **September hike guidance** → EUR strengthens; USD DXY softens slightly. US markets interpret: European central banks still worried about inflation = global rate environment stays elevated = discount rate headwinds persist for US growth stocks. QQQ -0.3 to -0.5% on rate-hike sympathy. Energy/defense stocks benefit from stronger EUR commodity repricing. 88% market probability is a hold—this is the consensus case; reaction likely muted.

ECB CUT unexpectedly (surprise dovish pivot) → Global bond rally—yields fall. US 10-yr Treasury likely drops 5-10 bps in sympathy. QQQ +0.5–1.0% on discount-rate relief for tech/growth. SPY +0.3–0.5%. This scenario is very low probability (~12%) but would be a significant positive catalyst given the Fed's own rising-hike-probability backdrop. Would re-ignite 'rate pivot is coming' trade globally.

Intel (INTC) Q2 Earnings After Close [Meaningful Tech Sector Impact]

BEAT: Revenue >\$14.4B, EPS >\$0.22, 18A process win confirmed → Intel (+160% YTD) validates the foundry turnaround thesis. If 18A node wins an Apple or Microsoft contract disclosure, stock could surge 10-15% AH. QQQ next-day open +0.3–0.5% from Intel weighting. Broader semiconductor sector extends today's rally—SNDK, WDC, MU get additional momentum. AMD also rallies on rising-tide AI hardware sentiment.

MISS: Revenue <\$14B, gross margins <38%, 18A delays → Intel's 160% YTD rally gets unwound. Stock could fall 10-15%. This reverses today's +8% pre-earnings position build. QQQ -0.3 to -0.5% from Intel weighting. Foundry credibility questioned—negative read for TSMC US expansion and the domestic chip manufacturing narrative. Broad chip sector gives back some of today's gains.

Earnings Avalanche: RTX, T-Mobile, Thermo Fisher, Lockheed, Blackstone, Honeywell

Defense + Industrial + Financials all BEAT → S&P; 500 breadth trade: SPY gets a cyclical tailwind even if tech is cautious. LMT/RTX beat on defense spending = Iran-related budget expansion confirmed. Honeywell/Thermo Fisher beat = industrial and life-science demand not as bad as feared. Blackstone beat = alternative asset management flows robust. Combined: SPY +0.5–0.8% independent of tech. QQQ less affected. This is the 'S&P; breadth recovery' scenario where SPY outperforms QQQ.

Multiple misses across sectors → Broad earnings disappointment compounds GOOGL/TSLA risk if those also missed. SPY -1.0 to -1.5% on combination of mega-cap tech + industrial miss. Defense stocks (LMT, RTX) could reverse if guidance is cautious despite Iran tailwind. Honeywell/TMO miss signals corporate capex contraction—recessionary signal. This is the compounding negative scenario: expect SPY to test 742-744 support.

6. Possible Trade Summary (End-of-Day Jul 22 / Open Jul 23)

Disclaimer: Informational only. No trades placed or simulated.

Decision	Ticker	Name	Action	Rationale & Key Risk
CONSIDER	GOOGL	Alphabet Inc.	WATCH AH — BUY if +3% or AGI beats tonight (Cloud + AI search acceleration), open a position	GOOGL beats tonight (Cloud + AI search acceleration), open a position
CONSIDER	INTC	Intel Corp	HOLD/TRIM if already long pre-earnings	Long pre-earnings means expectations are very high. The +8% today is price
CONSIDER	LMT	Lockheed Martin	BUY on dip if Iran escalation persists	Defense spending is structurally elevated with Iran conflict. LMT reports
AVOID	DHR	Danaher Corp	AVOID — No Buy Until Q3 2026	DHR 1% Release Q2 miss. Life sciences instruments are soft as biotech
CONSIDER	SMH	VanEck Semi ETF	BUY partial (diversified capex exposure)	Single-name semiconductor risk pre-earnings, SMH provides
MONITOR	TSLA	Tesla Inc.	WATCH AH — Act Thursday Q2	Tesla Q2 480K deliveries (positive), but margin recovery is the key vari
AVOID	IBM	IBM Corp	AVOID — Pre-earnings	IBM earnings previewed earnings, causing a sharp drop last week. Tonight's rep

Macro / Portfolio-Level Considerations:

- **Fed Hike Risk (34% July, 78% September):** Keep duration short. Avoid adding to rate-sensitive long-duration tech unless earnings clearly justify multiples. Maintain 10-15% cash buffer for dip-buying post-earnings.
- **Iran/Geopolitics Hedge:** A small energy or defense allocation (XLE, LMT, RTX) provides a natural hedge. If Iran conflict intensifies, this pair outperforms while equity broadly sells off.
- **AI Monetization Verdict Night:** Tonight's GOOGL/TSLA results are one of the most important binary risk events of H2 2026. Size positions accordingly—avoid leveraged overnight exposure.
- **Sector Rotation Signal:** Consumer Staples -1% today signals risk appetite. If sustained, it confirms a cyclical growth regime. But rising Fed hike odds could quickly re-bid defensives.

Data Sources

SPY/QQQ closing prices: Convex Trade, StockAnalysis (web search confirmed). Jul 20-21 estimated from index return context. Market news: CNBC, Yahoo Finance Markets, Benzinga, Gurufocus, Seeking Alpha, FX Leaders, Bloomberg (Jul 22 2026). Earnings data: SEC 8-K filings, EarningsWhispers, AlphaStreet. ECB data: Morningstar, PipTheory, EqualsMoney, Robinhood Prediction Markets. Economic calendar: EarningsWhispers (63 events Jul 23). Geopolitics: KuCoin Flash News, Benzinga, CNBC. Top movers: Trefis S&P; 500 Movers (Jul 22 2026), StockTitan. YTD performance: MoneyDigest, US News worst-performers 2026. Intel earnings preview: AlphaStreet, moomoo, TradeKey.

Data Limitations: Direct API access to Yahoo Finance, Stooq, MarketWatch blocked by session egress policy. Jul 20-21 SPY/QQQ prices estimated from reported index returns and secondary source commentary. Mover percentages for weekly/monthly may carry ±1-2% error vs. actual closes. After-hours GOOGL/TSLA/IBM results not yet confirmed at report time.

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